Canceling your account

Previously, we learned about how to update an account, register an account with a confirmation, and reset an account's password. Now, it's time for us to learn how to cancel an account.

This feature is provided to delete an account so that it won't be accessible anymore. By default, Devise provides this feature, and it can be accessed through the user edit page. As shown in the **Edit User** page, you can see a button labeled **Cancel my account**. If you press this button, Devise will delete your data from the database. So, if you want to access the application, you need to sign up again.

For some websites, data is like a treasure. Many websites don't perform deletions because they don't want to delete any data stored in their database. Instead of deleting it physically, the application will only change the flag of a data. Let's say, I have a user account that has a data flag, **published**. When I delete it, I don't delete the data but I change the flag of the data to **deleted**. But now, the question is how does Devise perform this method? Perform the following steps to know:

1. Create a migration file that will add a new column in the `users` table named `is_active` with the type, `integer`.
2. Add a method named `destroy` in `registration_controller.rb`, so it will contain the following code:

```
def destroy
  @user = User.find(current_user.id)
  @user.is_active = 0
  if @user.save
    sign_out @user
    redirect_to root_path
  else
    render "edit"
  end
end
```

3. Now, reload the user edit page and click on the **Cancel Account** button. You will be brought to the main page, but this time your data will not be deleted. It's now flagged with zero (**0**).

This is an example of many possibilities to be implemented as a replacement for data deletion. So, it depends on what you want to develop in your application.

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